

Golded Artifacts

#1 Amerisan Deal conversation

Why it is a golden artifact:

- The feedback back was spot on and very pragmatic and actionable
- Also pointed out things that I didn't do well and why
- Provided great responses to emails

Start of the deal conversation with Amerisan.

I sent a proposal to a prospect on Friday for a virtual workshop. My initial price was too high for their budget so I adjusted by 25% to win the business. Arne was meeting with his boss on Friday to discuss the proposal but I have not heard back from him yet. I'm assuming it's either a no go or them asking for a better price. I don't like that he hasn't provided feedback yet.

Mar 17

Prepared direct coaching on sales negotiation uncertainty

Prepared direct coaching on sales negotiation uncertainty

Here's what I'd tell you straight: the silence isn't your answer — but your instincts are right to be uncomfortable with it.

You're in the Red Zone on a deal where you've already made a significant concession. That changes the leverage dynamic. Here's the real risk — if Arne comes back and asks for more, you're negotiating from a weakened position because you moved 25% without getting anything in return. No committed next step, no verbal yes, just a revised number and hope. That's not a close. That's a soft serve.

A few things I'd want to know before advising the next move:

Did you and Arne have a scheduled follow-up after the Friday meeting, or did you just send the revised proposal and wait? If there was no confirmed next step tied to that boss conversation, that's the root issue here. The silence is a symptom.

And here's the harder question — who is the boss? Do you know them? Are you single-threaded through Arne? Because if Arne walked into that meeting without you having any relationship with his boss, the decision is being made without your voice in the room.

What I'd do right now:

Don't send a "just checking in" email. That's the worst play you can run here. Instead, reach out with a reframe. Something like this:

"Arne — I know your meeting with [boss name] was Friday. I wanted to reach out not to chase a decision, but to offer any support heading into the week. If there are lingering questions on the

investment, the outcomes, or the format of the workshop, I'd rather get on a 15-minute call and address them directly than leave anything on the table. When's a quick window today or tomorrow?"

You're not checking in. You're inserting yourself back into the deal with purpose.

If he's unresponsive to that, then you escalate — try a personal channel, text or LinkedIn DM, and keep it short. *"Arne, any direction from Friday? Happy to jump on a quick call."* That's it.

The bigger lesson for next time: before you adjust price, you need a committed next step and ideally a verbal yes in principle. "I'm meeting with my boss Friday" should have triggered a follow-up time blocked on the calendar for Monday — not a wait and see.

What does your relationship with Arne feel like — is he a champion or just a contact?

he told me on the call it would be a quick decision. His boss is Chester the CRO. one other data point, this is a family run business so Chester may not be the final decision maker

Mar 17

Identified hidden decision-maker risk in family business structure

Identified hidden decision-maker risk in family business structure

That family business detail is the most important thing you've said. That's not a footnote — that's a red flag you need to act on right now.

Here's the real picture: You've got Arne as your contact, Chester as the CRO, and somewhere above Chester there's likely a family member — founder, owner, patriarch — who can kill or bless any deal they want regardless of what Chester recommends. You don't know who that is. You don't have a relationship with them. And a decision is being made this weekend without your voice anywhere near that conversation.

That's not a stalled deal. That's a deal being decided in a room you were never invited into.

The Shadow Org Chart here probably looks like this:

Family Owner / Patriarch → Chester (CRO) → Arne

You're only connected to Arne. That's a fragile thread on a deal where the real power sits one or two levels above him.

What this changes about your next move:

Your outreach to Arne needs to do two things — not just check on the decision, but surface who else is involved. Try this:

"Arne — hope the conversation with Chester went well Friday. As I was thinking about it over the weekend, I want to make sure I've addressed any questions Chester or anyone else on the

leadership team might have before you finalize anything. Is there anyone else weighing in on this I should be aware of? Happy to jump on a quick call with you and Chester directly if that helps move things forward."

That last line is your play — you're asking for access to Chester. If Arne says yes, you've just multi-threaded. If he deflects, you've learned something about how much control he actually has.

The harder truth:

"Quick decision" from a buyer usually means one of two things — either it genuinely is simple and low friction, or they want to feel in control of the timeline and haven't told you about the real complexity. In a family business, "quick" can evaporate the moment the owner has a different opinion than the CRO.

You needed to ask Arne directly before that Friday meeting: *"When Chester reviews this, is he the final yes, or does anyone else need to weigh in?"* That question would have mapped the org chart and set your expectations.

What's your relationship with Arne like — does he seem like someone with real influence, or more of a facilitator passing things up the chain?

he is at best an influencer.

Mar 17

Recognized distinction between influence and decision-making authority

Recognized distinction between influence and decision-making authority

That's the real problem. And honestly, it reframes everything.

You've been selling to the wrong person. Arne can't close this deal — he can only carry your message upstairs. And right now, your message is sitting in a room with Chester and possibly a family owner, being filtered through someone who doesn't have the authority to say yes and may not have the credibility to champion it effectively.

You're not waiting on a decision. You're waiting on Arne to sell for you. That's a losing position.

Here's what actually happened Friday: Chester looked at the proposal, probably had questions, and either Arne couldn't answer them confidently or the family owner pushed back on the price and nobody knows how to respond. The silence isn't indecision — it's a conversation happening without you.

What you need to do:

Stop routing through Arne as your primary path. You need Chester directly. Here's how you get there without going around Arne in a way that burns him:

"Arne — I want to make sure Chester has everything he needs to feel confident about this. Would it make sense to get the three of us on a quick 20-minute call this week? I can address any questions directly and we can move forward faster than going back and forth. I'll make it easy — happy to send a calendar invite if you can confirm Chester's available."

You're not cutting Arne out. You're using him to get to the room where the decision is actually being made.

The concession issue:

This is also where the 25% price move gets dangerous. You gave that to Arne. Chester and the owner don't feel like they won anything — they didn't negotiate with you. So if price is still a concern, they have no emotional investment in the number you gave. They'll push again because from their perspective, they haven't tested your floor yet.

If Chester or the owner comes back wanting more, your response needs to be about value and outcomes — not price. Don't move again without getting something in return. Scope adjustment, commitment to a second workshop, a referral, something.

Bottom line:

You have an influencer who had a meeting you weren't in, with a decision maker you've never spoken to, at a family business where the real power is unknown. That's three layers of risk stacked on top of each other.

Get to Chester. This week. Before the deal dies quietly in a hallway conversation you'll never hear about.

lesson learned, i should have confirmed turnaround time on the decision and the process and i didn't that is why i'm in the dark now. i'll send the email you suggested above.

Mar 17

Validated user's insight and endorsed decisive action

Validated user's insight and endorsed decisive action

Exactly right. And to your credit, you're calling it clearly instead of making excuses. That's the mark of a good coach — you can diagnose your own gaps.

The lesson to carry forward is simple: every time a prospect says "we'll decide soon" or "I'm meeting with my boss," that's your cue to ask two questions before you hang up.

"What does the decision process look like on your end?"

"And if everything looks good, what's a realistic turnaround?"

Those two questions would have told you whether Arne had real authority, who else was involved, and when to expect an answer. You'd have gone into the weekend with clarity instead of assumptions.

Now go send that email. Keep it clean, keep it short, and don't over-explain. The goal is one thing — get yourself in a room with Chester before this decision gets made without you.

Let me know what Arne says. That response will tell you a lot about where this deal actually stands.

update on this deal. i'm meeting with chester and arne on thursday but price will be the biggest challenge. i may have to adjust the session to meet there budget needs.

Mar 18

Strategized negotiation tactics prioritizing value over price concessions

Strategized negotiation tactics prioritizing value over price concessions

Good news — you got the meeting. That's the win. Now don't give it away by walking in Thursday ready to negotiate against yourself.

Here's the thing about adjusting scope to meet budget: done right, it's a legitimate play. Done wrong, it's just another concession that trains them to keep pushing. The difference is in how you frame it.

Before you even think about scope adjustment, do this first:

Walk into Thursday with one goal — understand Chester's real number and what's driving it. Don't assume you know. Budget objections from a CRO in a family business could mean a dozen different things — cash flow, priorities, someone above Chester who hasn't blessed the spend, or just a negotiating habit. You need to know which one it is before you move anything.

Ask Chester directly: *"Help me understand the budget constraint — is this a question of overall spend, or is it about what the right investment looks like for the outcome you're after?"*

That question separates a real budget problem from a value problem. Those require completely different responses.

If scope adjustment is the right move, here's how to do it with leverage:

Never reduce scope as a concession. Reframe it as a trade. Something like:

"I want to make this work within your budget. Here's what I can do — if we focus the workshop on X and Y rather than the full scope, I can bring the investment down to meet your number. The tradeoff is we'd tackle Z in a follow-on session. Does that structure work for you?"

You've given something but you've also planted a second engagement. That's a trade, not a surrender.

The question you must ask Thursday:

You still don't know if Chester is the final yes. Family business, remember? Before you close anything, you need to know:

"Chester, assuming we land on something that works today — are you in a position to move forward, or does anyone else need to weigh in before we finalize?"

Ask it directly and early. Don't wait until you've rebuilt the proposal to find out there's a founder sitting above Chester who hasn't seen any of this.

What would Vince walk in with Thursday:

A clear value recap — not a new proposal, just a crisp one-pager that reminds Chester why this workshop matters to his team and his number. Pain, expected outcome, investment. Three lines. Let the value do the work before price ever comes up.

What's the core outcome the workshop is supposed to deliver for their team? That's what needs to anchor the Thursday conversation.

"Hello Vince, Chester and I just discussed this and, in discussing our overall agenda for our April training, it probably makes the most sense to postpone these discussions to a later date. We have a fairly full agenda and being that its virtual and only 1 day we don't think there will be enough time to dive into the Redzone selling content. However, we are interested in discussing for our next training in July. Could you postpone this meeting to sometime the 1st or 2nd week of April?"

2:34 PM

2 / 2

Identified stall tactics and strategized commitment-securing response

Identified stall tactics and strategized commitment-securing response

This is not a no. But it's also not a yes — and you need to treat it accordingly.

Here's what just happened: Chester and Arne made a decision about your proposal without you in the room again. Same pattern as before. The Thursday meeting you worked hard to get just got postponed via email before you could even show up and make your case.

The risk right now is that you reply with "no problem, happy to reschedule" and this quietly drifts into a maybe that never closes. July is three months away. A lot can happen between now and then.

Before you reschedule, get two things confirmed:

1. A real commitment to July — not "interested in discussing"
2. Scope clarity on what July looks like so you're not starting over

Here's the reply I'd send:

Arne — thanks for the update and glad to hear July is on the radar. I completely understand the April agenda is packed.

Happy to move our meeting to early April. Before I send a calendar invite, I want to make sure we use that time well. Can you share a bit more about what the July training would look like — size of the group, goals, format? That way I can come to the April conversation with something tailored rather than starting from scratch.

Also — just want to confirm, is July a firm date on the calendar or still being planned? Want to make sure I can support your timeline.

Let me know and I'll get something on the calendar.

Why this works:

You're agreeing to move the meeting without rolling over. You're asking questions that force them to either commit to July or reveal that it's still vague. And you're positioning the April meeting as a working session, not another exploratory conversation.

The harder truth:

That 25% concession you made is now sitting on the table for a deal that's three months out with no commitment attached. If July becomes real, you may need to revisit that number — you gave up margin for urgency that no longer exists.

Don't let this become a slow fade. Lock April down and use it to qualify July properly.

#2 Deal conversation - Ecomap

Why it works:

- Great analysis of the call with practical feedback and guidance

Sherrod H Davis - March 16 VIEW RECORDING - 28 mins (No highlights): https://fathom.video/share/DeS95FVHX-SZ32_yJyH1CqyRcEsL5vx9 — 0:00 - Sherrod Davis (EcoMap Technologies) I am late. It's okay. 0:02 - Vince Beese (vincebeese.com) It's okay. 0:04 - Sherrod Davis (EcoMap Technologies) Wh
pasted

Ecomap client, Sherrod is the CEO and founder. he needs my help adding rigor and execution to their sales process.

read the transcript and let me know your thoughts on the proposal. I was thinking a \$10k sales audit followed by \$5k per month in coaching. they are a small early stage startup so cost is a big factor.

here is the conversation to use to build the coaching proposal.

Mar 17

Analyzed pricing sensitivity and identified proposal friction points

Analyzed pricing sensitivity and identified proposal friction points

Good call. Let me give you my honest read on both the deal and the proposal structure.

THE DEAL — WHERE IT SITS

This is a Green Zone deal with real momentum. Sherrod has pain, urgency, and he likes you. But there are two things working against you right now.

First, he's a startup CEO managing runway. Cost isn't just a preference — it's a constraint. And he told you exactly where his head is: "we would definitely be more interested in the five than the ten." That's not negotiating. That's a signal. He's already anchored at five grand a month. When you come back with a separate \$10k audit on top of that, you're going to create friction right out of the gate.

Second, the deal still has a loose next step. You've got two open threads — the Dushan reference call and the proposal — but no committed date to reconvene and make a decision. That's a Scheduled Next Step gap. Protect the momentum.

ON THE PROPOSAL STRUCTURE

The \$10k audit plus \$5k/month coaching is the right value. My concern is how it lands given what he told you in the call.

Here's a cleaner way to think about it:

Roll the assessment into the engagement. Don't price it separately. Position the first 30 days as a diagnostic phase — you're in the pipeline reviews, you're listening to calls, you're mapping where execution is breaking down. That's the audit. It just happens inside the coaching relationship rather than as a standalone invoice before the coaching begins.

The pitch becomes: \$5k a month, three-month minimum, first 30 days is pure diagnosis before any coaching recommendations. By the time month two starts, you know exactly where the bodies are buried and you're already fixing it.

That structure gets you to \$15k over three months — same dollars as the \$10k audit plus one month at \$5k, but structured in a way that matches how Sherrod already told you he wants to buy. No upfront sticker shock. No separate line item to say no to.

If you want to protect the \$10k audit as a standalone offering, save it for clients who come in with bigger teams and bigger budgets. Sherrod is a three-seller startup where the CMO is also running sales. Meet him where he is.

RISKS TO WATCH

The Dushan reference call is a smart play, but it also introduces a pause. Don't let it stall the deal. Send the proposal before you make the Dushan intro, not after. You want Sherrod reading the scope while he's still warm from this call. The reference call becomes a confirmation, not a prerequisite.

One other thing — the beta tool offer. You offered it, he loved it, you said you won't charge for it. That's fine. But don't bury it in conversation. Put it in the proposal explicitly as an added value of the engagement. "As part of this engagement, your team gets beta access to the Red Zone Deal Coach." It costs you nothing and it differentiates you from anyone else he might be talking to.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

Send the proposal email before the Dushan lunch tomorrow. Strike while it's hot. Keep it short — one page. Scope, structure, price, and a clear ask to schedule a 30-minute call to review and align. Get that call on the calendar.

The deal is yours to lose right now. Don't let the reference call cool it off.

ok, to clarify, i told him there would be an audit fee so he is aware - just not the dollar amount. i would like to propose 3 months min. first month \$10k sales audit/coaching, then \$5k coaching there after

Mar 17

Validated cleaner pricing structure and prepared updated proposal

Validated cleaner pricing structure and prepared updated proposal

Got it. That's actually a cleaner structure than I laid out — and it makes sense. The first month is heavier lift for you anyway. Here's my updated take.

The structure is solid. The framing is everything.

Don't present month one as "the audit." Present it as the Diagnostic and Launch phase. Here's why — "audit" sounds like homework. "Diagnostic and Launch" sounds like you're already in motion. Same work, different psychology. Sherrod wants momentum, not an inspection.

Frame it like this in the proposal:

Month 1 — Diagnostic and Launch (\$10k): CRM review, pipeline meeting observation, call analysis, gap identification, and initial coaching sessions. Deliverable is a clear picture of where execution is breaking down and a 90-day coaching roadmap.

Months 2–3 — Execution Coaching (\$5k/month): Weekly pipeline sessions, call coaching, rep-level feedback, and strategic check-ins with Sherrod.

Total 3-month commitment: \$20k.

One thing to address head-on in the proposal

Sherrod already told you cost is a factor and he's leaning toward the lower number. He knows an audit fee is coming but he doesn't know it's \$10k. When he sees that, his first instinct may be to push back or ask if the audit can be skipped.

Get ahead of it. One line in the proposal does the job: *"The first-month investment is higher because the diagnostic work is what makes the coaching actually land — without it, we're coaching blind."* That's it. No over-explaining. Just anchor the logic.

The beta tool is still your closer. Put it in the proposal. It tips the value equation in your favor without touching the price.

Proposal for Rough Draft Atlanta (1).docx

155 lines
docx

can you build a proposal for me? include the Beta - Red Zone Selling Coaching (AI) as a condition for this price. attached is an example proposal i use for another client. this client is ecomap, and the Sherrod Davis, CEO, ecomap.tech

Mar 17

Ran 5 commands, edited 2 files, viewed a file

Ran 5 commands, edited 2 files, viewed a file

Here's the proposal. It follows the same structure and feel as your Rough Draft Atlanta template but is fully customized for Sherrod and EcoMap. Here's what's in it:

Cover page — clean, branded, addressed to Sherrod Davis, CEO.

Phase 1 (Month 1 — \$10k): Framed as "Diagnostic & Launch" — not an audit. Covers CRM review, pipeline observation, call analysis, and initial rep coaching, with a written 90-day roadmap as the deliverable.

Phase 2 (Months 2 & 3 — \$5k/month): Execution coaching scope with weekly pipeline sessions, rep-level call feedback, and strategic check-ins with Sherrod.

Investment summary table — clearly shows \$20k total over three months with month-to-month option after.

Beta access section — given its own full section, positioned as exclusive early access, not a throwaway line. This is your closer.

Next Steps — clean list including HubSpot CRM access so you can hit the ground running on day one.

One thing to note — I referenced HubSpot as the CRM in the next steps since that's what you use. If EcoMap is on a different system, swap that out before you send it.

Ecomap coaching proposal

Document · DOCX

#3 Deal conversation - Built

Why:

- Did a great job of building the proposal and strategy for delivery, again very practical with logical next steps.

Katie Wilson - Built - March 13 VIEW RECORDING - 28 mins (No highlights): <https://fathom.video/share/qyH7AZEMMpE7J9Bexzc8pSjUUs4YzSp4> --- 0:00 - Katie Wilson (getbuilt.com) Morning. How are you doing? 0:02 - Vince Beese (vincebeese.com) Can you hear me? 0:03 - Katie Wilson (getbuilt.com) I

pasted

Built is a current client and we are about to enter transition and conclude the first two phases of the project. I have recommended that they hire me as a coach, not just for the AM team for for the entire sales organization. in addition they as a company are looking for creative ways to utilize AI so i would also like to propose red zone selling ai coach.

Katie Wilson is my main point of contact but this would ultimately be signed off by her boss Scott Traina the GM and head of the entire gtm team.

Here is my last call with Katie where i propose the coaching and AI solution.

Before building the proposal, provide me your thoughts on the best way to tackle this.

one other piece of context, i have a personal relationship with rich williams who is the president of Built. we worked together at Experian.

Show more

Mar 17

Architected multi-threaded sales strategy leveraging executive relationships and timing

Architected multi-threaded sales strategy leveraging executive relationships and timing

Good timing to pressure-test this before you build anything. Here's how I see it.

You're sitting on a significant advantage that most people would underuse.

Rich Williams is the president of Built, he's driving the AI-native mandate company-wide, and you have a personal relationship with him going back to Experian. That's not a footnote — that's your biggest play here and it needs to happen before the proposal goes anywhere. You mentioned on the call you haven't reached out to him since October. That ends this week. Not to

go around Katie, but because this deal, if it gets to where it should be, gets signed at the Rich and Scott Traina level — not the Katie level.

Rich is also the one who assigned the AI-native directive. Your AI coach isn't a sales tool — it's a direct answer to his company-wide initiative. That changes how this is framed entirely.

The structural problem with the current setup.

Right now your champion is Katie. She's genuinely bought in, but she explicitly told you the decision runs through Scott Traina and that she's one of multiple function owners each putting together plans. Your proposal going in through Katie risks it being one line item in her plan competing against everything else she's pitching. That's not where you want to be. You want to be a line item in the exec conversation, not in Katie's deck.

The two offerings need to be positioned as one solution, not two separate asks.

The coaching retainer and the AI coach are actually the same pitch at the executive level: you're helping them build an AI-native sales function. The retainer is the human layer — the framework, the judgment, the rep-level coaching. The AI coach is the technology layer — the scalable, always-on execution of that same system. Together they're a complete answer to what Rich and Scott Traina are trying to build. Separately, they're two vendor conversations to manage.

The workshop today is your proof-of-concept moment.

The session happening tonight with the AM team is not just a workshop — it's a live demonstration for Katie and Scott Traina of what working with you looks like at scale. How you run that room, the specificity of your coaching, and whether reps walk out with immediately actionable language — that's your best sales tool for the bigger proposal. Make sure you walk away from tonight with a clear next step tied directly to the proposal conversation.

Here's the sequence I'd recommend before touching the proposal:

One, reach out to Rich this week. Keep it personal and light — rekindle the relationship, mention you're doing good work with his team, and ask for 20 minutes to share something you're building that aligns with what he's driving. You don't pitch on that call. You listen, get his language around the AI-native initiative, and let him connect the dots himself.

Two, run a great workshop tonight and debrief with Katie immediately after. Lock in a date with her to present the full proposal — and ask her directly whether Scott Traina should be in that room. If she says yes, that's your shot. If she hesitates, you use Rich to get there another way.

Three, build the proposal for Scott Traina's level, not Katie's level. It needs to speak in business outcomes — revenue confidence, rep retention, speed to competency on new hires, and directly tying to their AI-native mandate. Not "coaching sessions" and "call reviews."

One risk I want to flag.

Katie told you Built is also internally building some of this — Gong-based coaching, call scorecards, the AI-native plan. That means there's a "build vs. buy" conversation happening that you may not even be in. The way you neutralize that is by making the proposal about what they can't build internally — your judgment, your framework, and your 25 years of enterprise pattern recognition baked into the AI coach. The tech is just the delivery mechanism. That's not what they're building in Gong.

What do you want to tackle first — the Rich outreach strategy or structuring the proposal itself? I already reached out to Rich and sent him a calendar invite for the 24th, which now needs to be confirmed. Let's move forward with the proposal. Keep it as short as possible and clear. I don't want to overwhelm her or them. I think what I'll do is present to Katie to get feedback and then ask to get in front of Scott.

Mar 17

Architected concise proposal structure, identified critical pricing gaps

Architected concise proposal structure, identified critical pricing gaps

Before I build it, two quick things I need from you:

What does the retainer package look like — scope, cadence, and price point? And for the AI coach beta, what are you offering them — free, discounted, or a structured beta arrangement with defined terms?

Those are the only gaps. Everything else I can pull from the call and the context you've given me. Retainer is \$10k per month, first month \$15k to do an audit, similar cadence to the Amerisan deal. This would be a minimum of 3 months with the AI beta tool included, starting April 1st

Mar 17

Architected concise proposal with structured pricing and deliverables

Architected concise proposal with structured pricing and deliverables

Let me build this now. Clean, short, executive-ready.

Architecting clean proposal structure and format

Architecting clean proposal structure and format

Clean one-pager. Here's what's in it and why it's structured this way:

The framing positions both offerings as a single answer to two things Built already cares about — consistent sales execution and the AI-native mandate. It's not "here are two things you can buy." It's one engagement with two layers.

The investment table is straightforward — Month 1 audit at \$15k, \$10k/month after, AI beta included, \$35k total for three months. Simple math, no confusion.

The next steps section is deliberately set up for the conversation you described — Katie reviews, then you get in front of Scott together.

A couple of things to consider before you send it to Katie: the date on the proposal says March 2025 — confirm whether you want that updated to 2026 before it goes out. Also, if you want to add a one-sentence reference to the Phase 1 and 2 work you completed together, that context would strengthen the "we've already earned the right to this conversation" framing. Let me know and I'll adjust.

Built redzone proposal

Document · DOCX

Built_RedZone_Proposal_3_17_26.docx.odt

odt

I made some versions to the proposal. overall i feel its light and needs a little more context, outcomes, benefits, also a cover page - make to Scott Traina.

Mar 17

Examined proposal revisions to enhance depth and structure

Examined proposal revisions to enhance depth and structure

Let me read what you've got first, then build the enhanced version.

Synthesized feedback to strengthen proposal with enhanced depth

Synthesized feedback to strengthen proposal with enhanced depth

Good, I've got your edits. Now let me build this out properly — cover page to Scott, more depth on outcomes and benefits, your additions woven in.

Ran 2 commands, created a file, read a file

Ran 2 commands, created a file, read a file

Here's what was added and why:

Cover page — Clean, addressed to Scott Traina with his title, your name and credentials, dated and marked confidential. Sets the right tone before he reads a word.

Expanded Layer 1 and Layer 2 — Your edits are in, including the AI Deal Wizard and the automated MAPs/presentations. Each bullet now leads with a bold label so it's scannable.

New "What This Delivers" section — Five outcome boxes: pipeline confidence, faster rep ramp, AI-native org, consistent execution, and rep retention. This is the section that speaks Scott's language — business outcomes, not features.

New "About Vince" section — Short, credibility-forward, and ends with the line that matters most to Scott: Built is already a client and this builds on work already done.

Expanded Why Now — Connects to the AI-native deadline, the new hire (Chris), and the cost of delay in concrete terms.

One thing to flag before sending to Scott: you may want to add a brief note about the relationship context — either in a cover email or verbally when you present. The proposal itself is written as if Scott is reading it cold, but given you know Rich and have history with the org, your cover email sets that up better than the doc itself.

#4 Rich Williams - President at Built

Why:

- Great advice about how to conduct a conversation with an executive and what not to do.

i'm speaking with Rich Williams the President at Built tomorrow. I've know Rich for a long time from our days at Experian. my goal is to set the stage for me coming on as a sales strength coach and also using the AI Coach as a beta. give me some advice on how i should navigate the conversation.

6:01 PM

Contextualized peer conversation strategy over sales pitch approach

Contextualized peer conversation strategy over sales pitch approach

This is your most important conversation in the Built deal — and the easiest one to mishandle if you treat it like a sales call. Here's how I'd think about it.

The one thing to get right before anything else: this is a relationship call first.

You haven't talked to Rich since October. He's been heads down running two sides of the business. Lead with that — reconnect as peers before you get anywhere near the proposal. Ask about him, what he's been focused on, what the year looks like. If you rush past the relationship into the pitch you'll feel transactional, and that's the opposite of your advantage here.

Your actual advantage in this conversation is unique and you should use it deliberately.

Most vendors pitching Built right now are going in cold through Katie or Scott. You're going in through the president who knows you personally, knows how you think, and knows what kind of executive you are. That's not a minor edge — it's a structural one. Don't waste it by showing up with a deck mentality. Rich already trusts you. Your job is to remind him of that and then let him connect the dots to why you belong in this company.

How to frame the work you've already done.

You've completed two phases with Katie's team. Rich may know this exists but probably doesn't know the detail or the impact. Tell him specifically — not a feature list, but what changed.

Something like: "I've been working with Katie's AM team for the past few months. What I found is the same thing I see in most high-growth sales orgs — the reps are talented but there's no consistent system. Discovery is staying shallow, next steps are getting left open. We've started to

fix that." That's a sentence that makes Rich lean in, because he owns the revenue problem at the executive level.

The AI-native mandate is your opening into the bigger conversation.

Katie told you Rich is driving that directive personally. That means when the topic comes up — and you should raise it — you're not pitching him, you're aligning with something he already believes. The frame is: "I heard you're pushing the org to rebuild functions as AI-native. What I've been building is exactly that on the sales coaching side — an AI coach built on a real sales framework, not a generic tool." Then stop talking and let him react.

What you're NOT doing on this call.

You're not presenting the proposal. You're not asking for budget. You're not closing anything. The proposal is for the Scott Traina conversation — this call sets the conditions for that conversation to happen on your terms, with executive air cover. The goal is to walk away with Rich saying something like "you should definitely meet with Scott, I'll connect you" or "let me know what you need from me." That's the win.

The specific things I'd want to know coming out of this call:

What's Rich's personal read on where the sales org is weakest right now — not what's in the plan, but what keeps him up. How much is he actually involved in the Scott Traina conversation versus delegating it. And whether there's any political dynamic between the lender side and the owner-developer side that affects how this gets prioritized. Rich will tell you things in a peer conversation that no one else at Built will.

One tactical note on how to close the call.

Don't ask Rich to do anything specific unless he volunteers it. But do tell him directly: "I've put together a proposal for Scott. I'd love to get in front of him and walk him through it. I'm not asking you to do anything — just wanted you to know where things stand and make sure you think it's the right move for the org." That's clean. It respects the relationship, it respects the org chart, and it plants the seed for Rich to say "actually, let me make that intro."

The summary in one line:

Reconnect as a peer, tell him what you've already done and why it matters, align on the AI-native mandate, and leave him knowing you're about to bring something real to Scott. Then let him decide how involved he wants to be.

What time is the call — and do you want to pressure-test your opening?

yes

6:04 PM

Devised coaching strategy for call opening preparation

Devised coaching strategy for call opening preparation

Give me two things and I'll build it out for you:

What time is the call, and how are you getting on it — did Rich confirm or are you still waiting on him to accept the invite?

And when you picture the first 60 seconds of the conversation, what does your natural instinct tell you to say? Just talk it out like you're already on the call. I want to hear your version before I give you mine.

10am, confirmed, via google meet.

we will start the convo by catching up. its been over 6 months since we last communicated in any detail.

how's it going, how did you fair from the storm in february

6:16 PM

Architected conversational bridge from warmup into business discussion

Architected conversational bridge from warmup into business discussion

Good. That's a natural, human opening and you should let it breathe. Don't rush it. Rich is a busy executive who hasn't talked to you in six months — the warmup isn't filler, it's the foundation for everything that follows.

Here's how I'd think about the full arc of the first few minutes.

The warmup — let it run 5 to 7 minutes.

Storm, family, what he's been up to, how the year has started. You're not performing interest — you actually know this guy. Ask a real question about something specific to him. If you know anything about what he had going on personally — the compound he was building, anything — reference it. People remember when you remember.

The natural bridge into business.

At some point Rich is going to ask what you've been up to, or there'll be a natural lull. That's your moment. Don't wait for a formal transition — just step into it conversationally. Something like:

"Honestly it's been a great start to the year. I've actually been doing some work with your team over at Built — been coaching Katie's AM group for a few months now. It's been good work. I've gotten pretty deep into how the team operates."

Short. Matter of fact. Let him react. He'll either say "yeah I heard something about that" or "oh really, tell me more." Either way he's now asking you to continue rather than you pushing.

Then go straight to the observation, not the pitch.

"What I've found — and this isn't unique to Built, I see it everywhere — is that the reps are capable but there's no consistent execution system underneath them. Discovery stays shallow, calls end without real next steps. We've started fixing that with Katie's team. But honestly the same gaps exist across the whole sales org."

That's the sentence that lands with a president. You're not complaining about his team — you're diagnosing something he already suspects. And you're signaling you see the bigger picture, not just the AM slice.

Then let him pull the AI conversation out of you.

If he mentions the AI-native directive — and he likely will given it's his initiative — don't jump on it. Match his energy first. Ask him what's driving it, what he's hoping it actually changes. Get his language. Then:

"That's actually something I've been building. An AI coach built on my Red Zone framework — not a generic tool, something that actually coaches reps on their live deals. I'm looking for a beta partner to help shape it. Katie's already interested."

Then stop. Let him sit with it.

The one thing to avoid.

The moment you feel the conversation going well, there'll be a temptation to start presenting — features, pricing, scope. Resist it completely. Your job tomorrow is to deepen the relationship and get Rich leaning toward Scott having this conversation with you. That's it. The proposal does the rest.

How you'll know the call went well.

Rich volunteers something — an intro to Scott, an offer to put in a good word, or a direct "you should bring this to the team." If he does any of those without you asking, you've run the call perfectly.

What feels uncomfortable about any of that — anything you'd naturally veer away from?

good points, especially around don't go into pitch mode.

6:18 PM

Reinforced key messaging and prepared concrete takeaway

Reinforced key messaging and prepared concrete takeaway

That's the one that kills these calls most often — especially when you know the person and the conversation is going well. The comfort of the relationship actually makes it *more* tempting to pitch, not less. It feels like permission.

The way I'd think about it: Rich already knows you're good. You don't need to prove anything tomorrow. Your only job is to remind him why he likes working with you and make him feel like Built would be missing something if you weren't more involved.

If you walk away from that call and Rich felt like he was talking to a peer who's doing interesting work — not a vendor who showed up with an agenda — you've won.

One thing to keep in your back pocket for the close of the call. If the conversation has gone well and Rich hasn't volunteered anything, you can be direct without being pushy:

"I've put a proposal together for Scott. I'm not asking you to do anything with it — just wanted to make sure you knew where things stood and that you thought it made sense for the org."

That's it. Clean, no pressure, and it gives Rich the opening to say "actually, let me make that intro" if he's inclined to. Which he probably will be.

Go in tomorrow relaxed. You've earned this conversation. Let him do half the talking and you'll be in great shape.

Let me know how it goes.